

CANDIDATE THESIS

Turn scattered AI effort into operating capability.

The role objective is to turn fragmented company-wide AI demand into a governed portfolio of adopted workflow changes - then make successful patterns reusable without confiscating departmental judgment or creating a central bottleneck.

WHY THIS ROLE MATTERS NOW

Ontra publicly positions AI as foundational to its products and operating culture. The internal opportunity is to bring comparable rigor to how AI changes work across departments: one roadmap, practical enablement, explicit decision rights, disciplined tool/vendor choices, and evidence that separates a reusable pattern from a local success.

ACTUAL WORK

- Prioritize distributed AI demand.
- Implement practical workflow interventions.
- Build training, advocates, and a useful Community of Practice.
- Clarify security, data, procurement, legal, vendor, and human-authority boundaries.
- Measure adoption, value, quality, trust, and learning.

OPERATING TENSIONS

- Central roadmap vs department ownership.
- Speed to proof vs security and trust.
- Company enablement vs central bottleneck.
- Local utility vs enterprise reuse.
- Executive ambition vs frontline habit.

DECISION ARCHITECTURE

- What enters the roadmap, and why?
- Which intervention posture fits the work?
- Who retains judgment and exception authority?
- Which tool, data, vendor, permission, and escalation boundaries apply?
- What evidence permits scale, repair, local use, pause, or retirement?

HONEST COST OF INACTION

Duplicated experimentation, inconsistent controls, weak adoption, vendor proliferation, and lost institutional learning - not because teams lack initiative, but because each win has no durable path into shared practice.

OPERATING MODEL

AI Capability Charter

A use case becomes company capability only when four conditions are explicit before reuse is earned.

01 Work The recurring job or decision that becomes materially better, with the outcome that matters.	02 Owner The person accountable for judgment, exceptions, adoption, and the operating result.
03 Boundary What AI may access, change, recommend, escalate, or never do.	04 Proof The evidence that earns continued use, repair, broader reuse, or retirement.

VERIFIED PROOF MAP

- **Vape-Jet:** direct AI-first transformation across production, quality, support, enterprise systems, telemetry, training, and accountability.
- **DudeWorth:** direct AI-readiness, opportunity qualification, workflow design, human review, governance, and evaluation patterns.
- **Amazon:** launch execution, standard work, visibility, escalation, and customer-backward operating mechanisms.
- **Compunetics:** technical-business translation, quality systems, root cause, process controls, and high-reliability execution.

120-DAY CONTRIBUTION ARC

1. **Read:** map demand, work, tools, owners, boundaries, and adoption signals.
2. **Bound:** install intake, decision rights, practical guidance, training, and escalation.
3. **Prove:** run bounded interventions and instrument outcomes, trust, and behavior.
4. **Institutionalize:** publish capability patterns, strengthen advocates, rationalize tools, and shape the next roadmap.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

Where is AI demand already strongest - and where is it least visible?	Which workflows are important enough to redesign rather than merely accelerate?
Where should AI Operations own the mechanism, and where must departments retain authority?	What would make the Community of Practice useful rather than ceremonial?
After six months, what evidence would make this capability credible to the executive team?	

Primary sources: Ontra official company, careers, leadership, security, certification, and product pages; Director, AI Operations job posting; verified candidate evidence supplied by Russell Dudek.